CRICMASTER ULTRA · PLAYER GUIDE

Franchise Auction

The owner's guide: how to bid, what your purse can reach, and every command the room can use.

Who this is for — franchise owners and co-owners who will be bidding, and anybody in the auction group who wants to follow it. You need no admin rights for anything in this guide. If you are **running** the auction, read the admin guide instead.

What is in here

- Money: crore, lakh, and why a bare number is crore
- Bidding: the one command you will actually use
- Reading the board, and the three views worth knowing
- What your purse can really reach (the max-bid rule)
- Every rule that can refuse your bid, and what it means
- Retention and Right To Match, if your auction uses them
- Focus mode: why the group answers nothing else while a lot is live
- Homework: what to read in a DM the night before
- The whole command list, on one page

Every number in this guide is the shipped default. All of them are set per auction, and `/arules` *in the auction's group prints what this one actually uses.*

1. The shape of an auction

An admin builds a player pool and a field of franchises. Each franchise has an **owner** and any number of **co-owners**, and a **purse** to spend. Players then go on the block one at a time, as **lots**, in sets; the room bids; the highest bid when the clock runs out wins, and the price comes off that franchise's purse. When the pool is finished the admin publishes the squads, and the auction becomes a real league you play in.

Three things are worth knowing before your first lot:

- **Auction money is its own currency.** A purse cannot buy anything else in the bot, and your coins are worth nothing at an auction. The two never meet.
- **You bid for your franchise, not for yourself.** An owner and a co-owner are equals: either can bid, and both spend the same purse.
- **Bidding only works in the auction's group.** That is deliberate — a bid nobody in the room saw is how a price gets disputed. Reading works in a DM too.

2. Money: a bare number is crore

Every amount is read as **crore** unless you say lakh out loud. This is how the room talks, so it is how the bot listens:

```
/bid 15        →  ₹15 Cr
/bid 1.5       →  ₹1.5 Cr  (₹150 lakh)
/bid 75L       →  ₹75 lakh
/bid 75 lakh   →  ₹75 lakh
```

Every prompt the bot prints shows the next minimum in the same form, so the commonest move is typing back the number it just showed you.

3. Bidding

Bare `/bid` bids the next minimum. That is the one you will use most, and the one that cannot be fat-fingered with ten seconds on the clock. `/bd` is the short alias.

```
/bid           →  the next legal minimum, whatever it is
/bid 2.4       →  ₹2.4 Cr, if that clears the minimum
/bd 2.4        →  the same thing, fewer letters
```

The buttons are always at the bottom of the chat. Every new bid message (“ Mumbai bids ₹2.2 Cr · ⬆ Outbids Chennai”), the player's card and the countdown carry **quick-bid buttons** — the minimum and one step above it — and the older message loses its buttons, so you never tap a stale price. The pinned board has them too. They are shared: each press is checked against the franchise **you** own, and the exact price is baked into the button.

My Purse and **Status** sit under the bid buttons. They answer with a private popup — your purse, max bid, squad, overseas count and RTM cards, or who leads the lot and what beats it — and add nothing to the chat.

Dot shortcuts work in the auction group: `.bid`, `.bid 2cr`, `.purse`, `.squad`, `.board`, `.lb`, `.mybids`.

Many teams can bid at once. There is no pause for the room after a bid. If you and another team send a bare `/bid` at the same instant, both land, in order. Spam is stopped per person: one bid attempt a second, and a burst of taps pauses only your bidding for 15 seconds.

The clock warns you before the hammer. With the default clock (60 40 20 10 5) a player opens with 60 seconds. Any bid with less than 40 seconds left puts the clock back to 40. At 20 seconds the room gets the **1st warning** — “Selling X to Team for ₹…” — at 10 seconds the **2nd warning**, and the last 5 are counted down in one message, then SOLD. Both warnings carry the bid buttons. `/arules` shows this auction's numbers.

A bid that works gets no reply. Forty bids inside one lot would be forty messages on top of a board you are trying to read. Your message gets a reaction, and the board carries the new price within a tick (two seconds).

A bid that is refused always answers, and always names the number that would have worked instead. On a thirty-second clock, “invalid bid” is useless.

The one thing you cannot do is **bid against yourself**: if you are already the top bidder, a raise is refused. (The single exception is a Right To Match window, where the top bidder is invited to raise their own bid once — see section 8.)

One pair of hands per franchise, per lot

Owner and co-owners are equals — but not at the same moment. **Whoever bids first for a franchise holds that lot**, and the other one is refused by name until the next lot:

> “Alice is bidding for Mumbai on this lot — only one of you at a time, or you end up raising each other. The next lot is open to either of you.”

Two co-owners bidding the same player is not two tactics; it is one franchise racing itself up its own price, and the loser of that race is always the franchise. The claim clears the moment the lot does, so the next player is open to either of you again — and if an admin undoes the bid that claimed it, so does the claim.

Direct bids, if your auction allows them

Some rooms run a strict ladder. If your admin has turned **direct bids off**, a typed amount is refused, and the message names the number it would have been:

```
/bid 12   →  Direct bids are off in this auction
          →  Send /bid on its own to bid ₹2.4 Cr
```

Bare `/bid` and the board's buttons still work, so you can always bid — one step at a time. `/arules` says which way your auction is set.

4. The clock

- A lot stays on the block for **30 seconds** by default, and **every bid restarts it**.
- At 10 seconds left the room hears **going once**, at 5 seconds **going twice**.
- **Anti-snipe:** a bid landing inside the last few seconds pushes the clock back out, a limited number of times per lot. Many rooms set it to “any bid in the last 10 seconds gives everybody 10 more”. `/arules` prints the exact numbers your auction uses.
- The deadline is decided by the bot, not by the announcement: a bid that arrives after time is refused by the command itself, even if the room has not been told yet.

An admin can add time with `/aextend` — a dropped connection is not a snipe, so that does not spend the anti-snipe budget.

5. What your purse can actually reach

Your purse is not your maximum bid. The auction holds back enough to fill the squad slots you still owe, so you cannot spend your way into an illegal squad:

```
slots you would still owe  =  min squad  −  (squad + 1)
reserve                    =  slots × cheapest base price
max bid                    =  purse remaining  −  reserve
```

So a franchise one player short of the squad minimum may spend its last rupee — there are no slots left to protect. A franchise five short cannot. **This number is printed for you**: on the board, in `/apurse` and in `/asquad`. It is not a suggestion; a bid above it is refused.

Why it is a rule and not advice

A minimum squad size that was only checked at the end would be a complaint nobody could act on — the money would already be gone. Refusing the bid while there is still a slot to fix the problem with is the only version you can plan around.

Squad warnings update live. The board flags reserved slots, and /asquad and /apurse explain what your team still needs. With a maximum of 20, 16 signed players and no players below 84, a rule requiring four below 84 reserves all four remaining slots. Only players rated 83 or lower can fill them. Role minimums and overseas minimums reserve slots in the same way; maximums block extra signings.

6. Everything that can refuse a bid

In the order they are checked, each with its own message naming the number that would have worked:

Refusal	What it means
Not live	The auction is paused, nothing is on the block, or the clock has run out.
You lead already	You are the top bidder. You cannot raise your own bid.
Too small	Below the base price, or below the standing bid plus the next increment. The message prints the minimum.
Squad full	Winning this lot would take you past the maximum squad size.
Purse	You do not have the money.
Reachability	You have the money, but winning at that price would leave you unable to fill your remaining minimum slots at base price. See section 5.
Overseas cap	Too many players from outside the auction's home country.
Role rule	Either a role ceiling (an eighth bowler in a seven-bowler squad) or a role minimum you would no longer be able to reach.

Bid increments step up as the price climbs — ten lakh on top of ₹18 Cr is noise, and forty of those is a room falling asleep. `/arules` prints the whole ladder; a bare `/bid` always uses the right step for the current price.

7. The views worth knowing

None of these are in the slash menu (both menus are full at Telegram's 100-command ceiling), so they are listed here and behind `/ainfo`'s buttons.

Every card is yours, and closes. Admin answers included — a card you asked for carries a Close button that takes it out of the chat — useful in a group where the board is the message everyone is trying to read — and only you can press it. The `/ainfo` menu and the Sets card work the same way: they answer the person who sent the command, so if somebody else's card ignores your taps, send the command yourself for a copy of your own. The **pinned board** is the exception on both counts — its quick-bid buttons belong to the whole room, and it cannot be closed.

Command	What you get
`/aboard`	A personal copy of the live board, with quick-bid buttons. In a DM it comes without the buttons, since a bid outside the group is refused anyway.
`/ainfo`	Where the auction stands, plus a button for every view below. Start here if you remember nothing else.
`/arules`	Every number this auction runs by: purse, squad and overseas caps, role limits, base prices band by band, the bid ladder, the clock, retention, RTM, picks.
`/apurse`	Every franchise's purse, max bid and squad count (and RTM cards left). /apurse Mumbai for one of them.
`/asquad`	Your own squad as a table, with purse and max bid. /asquad Mumbai for somebody else's.
`/asets`	Every set and its state. /anextset for the next set's players, /anextplayer for who is up next.
`/asoldlist`	Everyone sold so far, set by set.
`/aunsoldlist`	Everyone unsold, including the accelerated set.
`/aretlock`	Who has kept whom, and whether the retention window is still open.
`/apicks`	The expansion pick order and whose turn it is.

8. Retention and Right To Match

Not every auction uses these. `/arules` shows them only when yours does.

Retention happens before the first lot opens: a franchise keeps some of the players it already had, at a price off the top of its purse. An admin **offers** the retention and **your franchise accepts it** — the Accept button on that card works only for that franchise's owner and co-owners. Nobody else can press it, admins included. A retained player is on your squad from that moment, and counts against every cap.

Mini auctions: your squad carries over. In a mini auction every franchise starts with last season's whole squad, each player at what he cost, and the rest of the purse to spend. Until the window closes you may **release** any of your kept players: `/arelease Gill`, or a bare `/arelease` for a button per player (each asks before it acts). He goes back into the auction and his price comes back to your purse. It works in a DM too. Only your franchise's owner and

co-owners can release its players.

Right To Match (RTM) lets last season's franchise take a player back at the price the room set. It runs as three short windows on one clock:

1. The **holder** (last season's franchise) is asked whether it wants to exercise the right at all.
2. If it does, the **top bidder** gets one last raise — and this is the one moment you may raise your own bid — or may stand.
3. The **holder** then matches that final number, or lets the player go.

You answer with one verb, whichever question is on the clock:

```
/artm yes      →  exercise it / match it
/artm no       →  decline / let him go
/artm stand    →  (top bidder) no further raise
```

Every window times out to the **safe** answer — decline, stand, decline — so a silent owner can never wedge the auction. The prompt names the owner and carries buttons, so you do not have to remember the command.

9. Focus mode: the group runs one thing at a time

While the auction is **live or paused**, its group answers auction commands and **nothing else**. Try anything else and you get one line back:

> “ **Season 2** is on the block. Only auction commands work in this group while it runs — `/bid`, `/ainfo`, `/aboard`, `/apurse` and the rest of the a-commands. Everything else still works in a DM with me.”

The reason is the board: a thirty-second clock and a pinned message being edited every two seconds cannot share a room with a `/claim` card, and a bid that scrolls past unseen is how a price gets disputed.

- **Talking is never blocked.** Shout all you like — half of an auction is the room.
- **Only this group.** Your DMs, and every other group, are untouched. The whole rest of the bot is one DM away.
- **Non-auction buttons** tapped in the group are refused the same way, as a pop-up alert.
- **Nothing is locked before it starts.** While the auction is still being set up, the group behaves normally.

An admin can turn it off for a particular auction with `/afocus off`; `/afocus` on its own says which way it is set.

10. Homework: what to read the night before

Every read-only view answers **before** the auction starts, and answers in a **DM** — because working out what your purse can reach, what the sets hold and what retention cost you is homework, and doing it in the group means doing it in front of the people you are about to bid against.

```
/arules        every number the auction will run by
/asets         what the pool holds, set by set
/apurse        every purse, including what retention cost
/asquad        who you already have
/ainfo         how far setup has got
```

In a DM the bot works out which auction you mean from the franchise you own. If you have teams in two auctions at once it will say so and name them, rather than guess — ask in that auction's group instead, where the question is unambiguous.

What does not work in a DM: `/bid` and `/artm`. Both belong to the room.

11. Every command you can use

Command	Who	What it does
`/bid [amount]` · `/bd`	owner + co-owners	Bid. Bare /bid bids the next minimum.
`/artm yes|no|stand`	the holder / top bidder	Answer an open Right To Match.
`/arelease [player]`	owner + co-owners	Release one of your kept players back into the auction while the window is open.
`/aboard`	anyone	The live board, with quick-bid buttons.
`/ainfo` · `/amenu`	anyone	Where the auction stands, and a button per view.
`/arules` · `/asettings`	anyone	Every rule and number this auction uses.
`/apurse [team]`	anyone	Every purse, max bid and squad count.
`/asquad [team]`	anyone	A squad as a table.
`/asets`	anyone	Every set and its state.
`/anextset`	anyone	The next set's players.
`/anextplayer`	anyone	Who is up next.
`/asoldlist`	anyone	Everyone sold, set by set.
`/aunsoldlist`	anyone	Everyone unsold.
`/aleaderboard` · `/alb`	anyone	Franchises ranked by spend, with each one's top buy.
`/amybids [team]`	anyone	Every player you bid on — won, lost or live.
`.bid .purse .squad …`	as the command	Dot shortcuts, in the auction group.
`/aretlock`	anyone	Who kept whom; the retention window.
`/apicks`	anyone	The expansion pick order, and whose turn.
`/atrade <team>`	owner + co-owners	Trade players, cash or both with another franchise (IPL rules).
`/atrades` · `/atradeblock`	anyone	The trade log; the players franchises will listen to offers for.
`/atradecash` · `/atradecancel`	owner + co-owners	Set the cash on your offer; call it off.
`/atradehelp`	anyone	The full trade guide and every trade command.

If you forget all of it: `/ainfo` puts every one of those behind a button.

11a. Trades

- `/atrade Chennai` opens a trade card. Tick your **Trade out** and their **Trade in**, add cash with the ± buttons, then Send. The other franchise taps Accept, Reject or Counter.
- **The money is the IPL's:** the side taking a player pays his auction price, the side letting him go gets it back, and any cash moves on top. All-cash deals and player + cash deals are allowed.
- **Four windows:** before the auction, mid-auction (between lots, never while you hold the standing bid), after it, and mid-season until the deadline — the playoffs always close it.
- Every squad rule still holds: the squad limit, the overseas cap, role and rating rules, and the purse you must keep to finish your squad. A player moves once per window.
- **The bot admin approves.** Once both sides agree, the trade waits for the bot owner's Approve or Veto.

12. Quick answers

“Why was my bid refused?”	The refusal says which rule, and prints the number that would have worked. Section 6 lists all of them.
“The board says my max bid is less than my purse.”	That is the reachability reserve — money held back to fill the squad slots you still owe. Section 5.
“My /claim did not work in the group.”	Focus mode: the auction is live. Use a DM. Section 9.
“Can my co-owner bid for us?”	Yes — but one of you at a time on a lot. Whoever bids first holds it; the next lot is open to either of you. Section 3.
“/bid 12 was refused, but /bid worked.”	Direct bids are off in that auction: every raise is one step. Section 3.
“Somebody else's card ignores my taps.”	Cards belong to whoever asked for them. Send the command yourself. Section 7.
“Can an admin bid for me if my phone dies?”	Yes, from the website console — and it is announced as an admin's bid, not as yours.
“I missed a player I needed.”	Unsold players usually come back once, as the ⚡ Accelerated set, before the auction finishes. /aunsoldlist has them.
“My squad is short at the end.”	Squads under the minimum are topped up for free from whoever is still unsold, inside the squad and overseas caps.

Nothing in this guide needs admin rights. The auction's own numbers — purse, clock, caps, ladders — are whatever your admin set, and `/arules` *always prints the live ones.*